5.1 Introduction

Housing is one of our basic needs. Home is where our heart lies. Nowadays, the space in the home is of great importance because it is limited. Due to over population, land has become very expensive. Therefore, within less available space, many apartments are constructed to accommodate many families. When we purchase our homes, we need to consider many factors to ensure safety and economy. We have a number of equipment, furniture, furnishings at home and they need to be properly organised and arranged to provide maximum convenience and comfort. To lead a happy, satisfying life, our interiors must have pleasing environment in terms of colour schemes, furniture, furnishings and accessories.

House is a shelter made of floors, walls, windows, roof etc where family members live together and spend maximum part of their life. Housing, next to food and clothing, satisfies one of the basic needs of man. According to National Building Organization a **house** is defined as a **pucca or semi-pucca unit** of dwelling that can accommodate an average household. Its importance is given below:

5.1.1 Importance of house

1. The house protects the family members from excessive cold and heat, wind and rain and from all external anti-social elements.
2. A house is a physical structure consisting of walls, doors, windows, roofs, etc. in which human beings live and seek refuge from tensions and worries of the outside world.
3. The house forms the centre of family life. It is a place where family members are bound together by love and affection and enjoy group living.
4. The house provides space for group and individual activities for the members of the family such as cooking, serving, washing, storage, disposal of waste, recreation, reading and hospitality.
5. The house offers facilities for self-expression and a degree of freedom of action.
6. A good house provides a healthy environment for its members to develop their personality, attitudes, values and a sense of security in addition to rest and privacy.
7. An individual acquires customs, traditions, habits and culture of the family only in the house.
8. House is the place where some family members who cannot support themselves for reasons of sickness, unemployment, old age, widow-hood or other handicaps get shelter and care.
9. Housing is the determining factor for the standard of living of a family and act as a status symbol of a family.
10. Housing contributes to national income, national wealth and national employment.

XII Std - Home Science EM_Unit 5.indd 124 23-03-2020 3.31.30 PM